Common Mistakes to Avoid: Just as important as what to do is what **not** to do. Try to steer clear of these pitfalls when crafting your one-minute tales:

- *Taking too long to get to the point:* If viewers are 15 seconds in and still don't know what the conflict or purpose is, they'll likely drop off. Don't slow-burn your story setup in this format.
- *Overloading with information:* Extra characters, multiple twists, or lots of stats/facts can overwhelm a short story. Save complexity for longer content; keep short stories streamlined.
- *Ending abruptly without resolution:* While open-ended can work if it's a series or a mystery vibe, generally a short video should give some payoff. An unresolved random cut feels like the video just failed to load the rest.
- *Copying trends without a story:* Using a trending dance or meme is fine, but try to incorporate a narrative into it if your goal is storytelling. Simply following a trend isn't the same as telling a story – you can do both!
- *Ignoring sound/captions:* Many people might watch without sound, so if your story is told via dialogue, make sure to caption it on screen. Conversely, if your visuals aren't clear, a bit of narration or text can clarify. Cover your bases so the story can be understood by all viewers.

By keeping these tips in mind, you'll significantly increase the chances that your short video not only holds attention but also resonates with your audience.